

# ANN TROPEA

BALTIMORE, MD • (443) 903-5016 • [anntropea@gmail.com](mailto:anntropea@gmail.com) • [LinkedIn](#)

## CAREER PROFILE

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Experienced communications, editorial, and media leader with extensive experience directing complex teams, workflows, and strategic initiatives across higher education, publishing, digital media, and communications environments. Proven success developing and leading integrated communications strategies across print, digital, audio, social, and multimedia platforms, including oversight of student-run media organizations, national print publications, podcasts, newsletters, and public-facing campaigns. Skilled in editorial leadership, strategic planning, media advising, content production, stakeholder engagement, and collaborative program development, with demonstrated expertise managing cross-functional teams, budgets, and high-impact learning experiences. Strong combination of editorial judgment, technical fluency, and operational leadership, including experience with publication production workflows, SEO strategy, HTML, Adobe Creative Cloud, CMS platforms, analytics tools, digital communications systems, and emerging AI technologies.

## KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

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- Created and lead new Student Media Collective at UMBC to include four student-run media groups; tripled cross-divisional funding and manage 145K+ budget.
- Conducted and published high-profile interviews with top military leaders as Editor-in-Chief of *Seapower* Magazine, including Admiral Linda Fagan, Commandant of the U.S. Coast Guard.
- Created, co-hosted, and produced two innovative podcasts; Voices of the Sea at the Navy League of the United States, and an irreverent career-focused podcast at Career Valet.
- Remotely managed editorial staff of 10+ and 400+ writers worldwide for startup news website; tracked priorities with website developers in U.S. and abroad.

## SELECTED EDITORIAL & COMMUNICATIONS EXPERIENCE

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**UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND, BALTIMORE COUNTY (UMBC)**, Baltimore, MD      2023-present  
**Assistant Director for Engaged Media, Center for Democracy and Civic Life**

### *Courses Taught*

- ENGL320: Editing for Impact (magazine editing/production); Writing with Sound (audio editing/production); Legal Writing (legal analysis and writing)
- University Leadership: Podcasting Essentials (audio production); UNIV 101 (first year seminar)

### *Editorial Leadership, Strategic Storytelling, and Platform Management*

- Lead editorial vision, strategic planning, and cross-platform storytelling initiatives for the Student Media Collective, including The Retriever (newspaper), WMBC (radio), Bartleby (creative arts journal), and The Review (research journal).
- Direct content strategy and organizational messaging across print, audio, digital, and social platforms to strengthen audience engagement, institutional visibility, and civic learning outcomes.
- Serve as lead advisor and editorial strategist for student media leaders, providing guidance on reporting, editing, multimedia production, audience development, and ethical storytelling practices.
- Build and sustain collaborative relationships across academic and administrative units to align media initiatives with broader institutional narratives and strategic priorities.
- Facilitate editorial and leadership meetings that support collaborative decision-making, long-term planning, and high-impact student learning experiences.
- Lead editorial and academic advisory boards while promoting understanding of student media's role, policies, and procedures across the university community.

### *Communications Strategy and Audience Engagement*

- Relaunched and oversee a multi-audience newsletter strategy with an average open rate exceeding 60%, strengthening internal and external engagement through targeted editorial planning and content development.
- Contribute to institutional communications strategy, initiative development, and narrative framing related to civic engagement, democratic learning, and public-facing programming.
- Design and facilitate programs integrating journalism, storytelling, and civic engagement into interdisciplinary student learning experiences.

- Collaborate across teams to translate complex civic and institutional concepts into accessible, audience-centered content and programming.

**NAVY LEAGUE OF THE UNITED STATES**, Arlington, VA

2023

**Editor-in-Chief, *Seapower* Magazine**

*Editorial Vision and Multi-Platform Publishing Leadership*

- Directed editorial vision and publishing strategy for a historic national media brand spanning print, web, newsletters, and digital content platforms.
- Curated and prioritized high-impact editorial content focused on defense, maritime policy, leadership, and technology for broad public and professional audiences.
- Managed cross-functional editorial, design, communications, and marketing teams to produce cohesive, audience-driven storytelling across multiple channels.
- Led strategic advertising and sponsorship conversations with senior leadership and agency partners to align editorial, revenue, and audience engagement goals.
- Oversaw editorial calendars, production schedules, and publication workflows for all Seapower and Navy League media assets.
- Managed newsroom operations for daily publication coverage at Sea-Air-Space, the largest maritime exposition in North America.

*Narrative Development and Executive Communications*

- Wrote and edited speeches, op-eds, public remarks, and executive communications for senior organizational leadership.
- Conducted high-profile interviews and developed longform editorial content translating complex military and policy issues into accessible narratives for public audiences.
- Represented organizational communications priorities with senior defense and government stakeholders, including at the Pentagon.

**THREE SHIPS** (digital marketing firm), Raleigh, NC

2022-2023

**Editor**

*Editorial Strategy and Digital Audience Growth*

- Led SEO-focused editorial strategy for high-performing digital content campaigns, increasing search visibility and audience reach across key publications.
- Developed scalable editorial templates and workflow systems using HTML and CMS best practices to streamline production and improve efficiency.
- Conducted content analysis and audience research to identify strategic opportunities for growth, engagement, and conversion optimization.
- Managed writers and editorial workflows to ensure consistency, quality, timeliness, and alignment with broader content strategy goals.
- Edited and optimized content across platforms for editorial quality, discoverability, audience engagement, and conversion performance.

**CAREER VALET** (business writing and branding company), Baltimore, MD

2019-2023

**Communications Consultant** (2023); **Director of Communications** (2022-2023); **Senior Writer** (2020-2022); **Writer** (2019-2020)

*Communications, Brand Storytelling, and Multimedia Content Strategy*

- Led integrated communications and content strategy across social media, web, video, training, and digital learning platforms.
- Created and managed multi-platform storytelling campaigns designed to increase visibility, audience engagement, and brand cohesion.
- Produced and edited multimedia content including videos, podcasts, presentations, blog content, and social campaigns.
- Designed and developed digital training materials, instructional content, and audience-facing educational resources.
- Supervised writers and managed collaborative editorial workflows across multiple simultaneous projects and deadlines.

- Conducted trainings and developed internal knowledge resources supporting communication quality, editorial consistency, and professional development.

**CLEO** (series-C funded family benefits tech startup), San Francisco, CA

2019-2022

**Family Guide** (equivalent to portfolio manager)

*Management and Strategic Leadership*

- Managed portfolio of 250+ subscriber families, providing superior level of support while maintaining consistent organizational tone that reflects mission goals and company culture.
- Supported overall guide team, assisting team members with workloads, workflows, and specific guidance related to my areas of professional expertise as a birth doula, attorney, and writer.
- Contributed to strategic planning and content development for ongoing Return to Work project.
- Mentored, and trained two new team members, resulting in high-performing members of guide team.

*Business Strategy and Communications*

- Developed content for multiple projects, including App, articles, and internal reference library.
- Operationalized Mental Wellness Pilot and workflow as part of program pilot, including testing workflows through direct family support, and presenting findings during strategy meetings.
- Led and designed two trainings for 100+ staff; *Intro to Legal Issues for Family Guides* and *Getting from Here to Baby: Trying to Conceive for LGBTQ Families*.

**THE LATEST** (online news startup), Los Angeles, CA

2017-2018

**Managing Editor**

*Editorial Operations and Digital Media Management*

- Managed a globally distributed editorial team producing daily digital news and multimedia content in a fast-paced publishing environment.
- Directed editorial workflow, content selection, fact-checking standards, and style guide implementation across the platform.
- Coordinated cross-functional priorities between editorial, technology, and marketing teams to support publication goals and audience growth.
- Managed social media strategy and digital publishing across Twitter, Facebook, and Instagram, producing timely, audience-focused content tied to breaking news and cultural trends.
- Created and maintained site-wide editorial standards grounded in AP and Chicago style guidelines.
- Produced original editorial writing and video content designed to strengthen audience engagement and platform identity.

**Selected Other Roles:** Expert Witness Deposition Attorney (2011-2012); Barrasso Usdin Kupperman Freeman & Sarver, Associate Attorney, New Orleans, LA (2009-2011); Owner/Managing Partner, Fenton and Fenton, LLC, Chicago, IL (2011); Associate Publisher, GO NYC Magazine, New York, NY (2003-2004)

## ACADEMIC EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

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- Managing Editor, Law Journal, Loyola University Chicago School of Law
- Brief Writer, National Moot Court Team, Loyola University of Chicago School of Law
- Editor-in-Chief, *Medium Cool*, New York University

## SELECTED LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

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- **Communications Officer**, Executive Committee, Exempt Staff Senate, UMBC, Baltimore, MD (2025-present)
- **Elected Member**, Strategic Planning Committee, UMBC, Baltimore, MD (2024-present)
- **President, Board of Directors**, 32nd Street Farmers Market, Baltimore, MD (2024)
- **Editor**, Ednor Gardens-Lakeside Community Newsletter, Baltimore, MD (2021-2023)
- **Volunteer Birth Doula**, Community of Hope, Washington, D.C. (2018-2019)
- **Project Coordinator**, Anike Foundation, Boston, MA (2017-2019): Managed projects and volunteer activities between NGOs in Africa and global partner organizations.

## EDUCATION

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- **Juris Doctor**, Loyola University of Chicago School of Law | Chicago, IL
- **Bachelor of Science *magna cum laude***, Communication Studies (concentration: mass media) | New York University | New York, NY
- **Professional Development:** Adult and Pediatric First Aid/CPR/AED, American Red Cross; Chicago Intellectual Property Colloquium, Fellow (2008); U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Illinois, Judicial Intern (2007)

## SELECTED PRODUCTION, PUBLICATIONS & SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

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- Podcast creator, co-host, and producer, [Career B\\*tches](#), Career Valet (2022-present)
- [I'm a doula, but also an AI doula](#), Computational History (Jun 2026)
- Speaker, College Media Association National Conference, D.C. (Oct 2025)
- Production/research assistant, *The Truth is Fireproof*, (documentary feature, in production 2025)
- Editor-in-Chief and writer, [Seapower Magazine](#), Navy League of the United States (2023)
- Podcast creator, co-host, and producer, [Voices of the Sea](#), Navy League of the United States (2023)
- Camera operator, *The Truth in this Art*, (Podcasting in Place series, 2023)
- Production assistant, [Sound Mechanic](#), feature documentary (2022)
- Panelist, Partnership for a Secure America, Washington, D.C. (Sept 2022)
- Speaker, Veteran Transition Panel, University of Maryland Smith School of Business (Apr 2022)
- Speaker, Multiple Act Careers, Montgomery Women (Feb 2022)
- Podcast, [Birth Trauma](#), The Top Knot Squad (Jun 2021)
- Featured in [Oi Vietnam](#) magazine, Issue #75 (2019)
- Editor and publisher, *Global Gastronomy: Cooking Post to Post*, U.S. Consulate Jerusalem (2018)
- [It's Time to Fall in Love ... With Bugs](#), The Latest (2017)
- *Mental Doping: The Untold Story of Modern Law School Exams*, 38 Student Lawyer 5 (2010)

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

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- **Bar Memberships:** Louisiana (inactive); D.C. (inactive)
- **Military Service:** United States Marine Corps, honorable discharge (1996-2000)
- **Technical:** Google Workspace, Wix, Canva, WhatsApp, Trello, Slack, MailChimp, WordPress, Front, Calendly, Intercom, Zoom, Google Calendar, Google Analytics, Microsoft 365, Premier Pro, Adobe Creative Cloud (InCopy, InDesign, Express) Hootsuite, Buffer, HTML, SEMRush, Blackmagic 4K, Asana, Discord, SquareSpace, Basecamp; Codex; GitHub; Open-source AI
- **Languages:** English (native), French (intermediate)